Document A: Constitution

1 Name

1. The Society shall be called the Trinity College Science Society.
2. The customary abbreviated name of the Society is 'TCSS'.

2 Objectives

1. The Society will aim to promote the discussion, understanding and enjoyment of science within the College of the Holy and Undivided Trinity in the Town and University of Cambridge (henceforth referred as "Trinity College") and the University of Cambridge as a whole, primarily through organising speaker talks and social events.

3 Senior Treasurer

1. The Committee must secure the agreement of a Fellow of the College to serve as Senior Treasurer and, in that capacity, to advise the Committee and the Society on governance and financial matters and, where appropriate, to liaise with the College on behalf of the Society.
2. The Senior Treasurer:
   (a) may attend any meeting or activity of the Society; and
   (b) may see any document and inspect any property of the Society; but
   (c) is not a Member of the Society and is not liable for any debt or other obligation of the Society.

4 Powers

1. Subject to this Constitution, the Society has all powers that may be exercised by or on behalf of an unincorporated association by law and are necessary or convenient for carrying out the Objectives.
2. The Society must:
   (a) operate in a fair and democratic manner and be accountable for its finances; and
   (b) operate in accordance with the applicable general law and the applicable Statutes, Ordinances, regulations policies and procedures of the College; and
   (c) not employ staff; and
   (d) not trade in goods or services, whether for profit or otherwise, except for selling goods and services directly in connection with a performance, event, publication, merchandise or other activity conducted by the Society.

5 Application of income and property

1. The income and property of the society shall be applied solely towards the promotion of the objects outlined in the constitution of the society, and no part of the property or income shall be paid or otherwise distributed, directly or indirectly, except in good faith in the promotion of the objects.
2. No income or property of the society may be paid or transferred directly or indirectly to committee members or members of the society, except (i) as a refund of reasonable

expenses, or reasonable remuneration for goods or services, properly authorised and incurred on behalf of the Society, or (ii) as members of the class of persons for whose benefit the society exists. Reasonable expenses associated with the Society's activities include but are not limited to expenses incurred through dinners with speakers, refreshments at events, and transport and accommodation costs for speakers.

3. The society shall maintain an account with a bank authorised by the Prudential Regulation Authority and the Financial Conduct Authority. All bank accounts should be in the full name of the society.
4. The President, Junior Treasurer and Senior Treasurer shall have authority to operate all accounts and access all financial records of the society. To perform a transaction, receipts must be provided, and a record of all receipts for transactions must be kept.

6 Membership

1. Ordinary membership of the Trinity College Science Society shall be open to all junior members of Trinity College.
2. The Senior Treasurer is an *ex officio* Ordinary member of the Society.
3. The Society may offer associate membership to other matriculated members of the University who are not junior members of Trinity College. Eligibility for associate membership and the application process, if any, shall be determined by the Committee.
4. The Society shall not normally offer life membership or honorary membership.
5. Membership shall be terminated when a person (i) ceases to be eligible to be an ordinary or associate member, (ii) gives written notice of their intention to terminate their membership, or (iii) is excluded from membership.
6. A member may be excluded from the Society for conduct which is seriously detrimental to the interests of the Society or incompatible with its objects. The decision to exclude a member shall be made by a unanimous vote of the Committee or a two-thirds majority of the members present and voting at a General Meeting. The member shall be given reasonable notice of the meeting and the basis for the motion, and a reasonable opportunity to be heard. Any appeal shall be dealt with in accordance with the Society's complaints/grievance procedure.
7. The Secretary shall maintain a register of members and make it available to any member, the Senior Treasurer, or any person authorised by law to inspect the register.

7 Committee

1. Subject to this Constitution, and in accordance with motions passed at General Meetings, the Committee is to manage the affairs of the Society, and has all the functions and powers necessary or convenient for that purpose, including the power to make reasonable by-laws.
2. In compliance with the guidelines of the ACC, the Society shall elect a committee consisting of at least:

- A President,
- A Secretary, and
- A Junior Treasurer

3. There shall also be elected:

- A Vice President,
- A Publicity and Events Officer,
- A Speaker Liaison Officer,
- A Social Secretary,
- A Logistics Officer, and
- A Graduate Representative

4. The roles of the Committee Members shall be as specified in Section 8 of this Constitution.
5. All committee members must be Ordinary Members in order to run for office.
6. Any Graduate Representative must also hold membership of the Trinity College BA Society.
7. A Committee Member holds office:
   (a) in the case of a Committee Member elected at the Annual General Meeting, from the first day of full Easter Term.
   (b) in all other cases, from the time of the Committee Member's election or co-option.
8. A Committee Member holds office until:
   (a) the first day of full Easter Term; or
   (b) the Committee Member resigns by giving notice to the Secretary or, in the case of the Secretary, to the President; or
   (c) the Committee Member ceases to be an Ordinary Member; or
   (d) the Committee Member is removed in accordance with Section 10

8 Duties of Committee Members

1. President: The President shall be the chief officer of the society and shall preside over all meetings. The duties of the President shall include, but not be limited to: (a) representing the society in official capacities; (b) providing leadership and direction to the society; (c) coordinating the activities of the society; (d) ensuring that the society is managed in accordance with its constitution and bylaws; (e) acting as the liaison between the society and external organizations; (f) ensuring that all officers and committee members carry out their duties; (g) performing any other duties as directed by the committee, (h) or distributing these duties among other members of the committee.
2. Vice President: The Vice President shall assist the President over all affairs. The duties of the Vice President shall include, but not be limited to: (a) coordinating the activities of the society; (b) ensuring that the society is managed in accordance with its constitution and bylaws; (c) acting as the liaison between the society and external organizations; (d) ensuring

that all officers and committee members carry out their duties; and (e) performing any other duties as directed by the committee.

3. Secretary: The Secretary shall be responsible for all non-financial records of the society. The duties of the Secretary shall include, but not be limited to: (a) giving notice and preparing the agenda for meetings; (b) managing the society's correspondence; (c) maintaining the society's non-financial records; and (d) performing any other duties as directed by the committee.
4. Junior Treasurer: The Junior Treasurer shall be responsible for the financial affairs of the society. The duties of the Junior Treasurer shall include, but not be limited to: (a) ensuring that the society's monies and property are received and properly accounted for; (b) maintaining records that correctly record and explain the financial transactions and financial position of the society and that enable true and fair accounts to be prepared and audited from time to time; (c) keeping the committee informed of progress against the annual budget; (d) securing funding and bank account; (e) coordinating events; (f) performing any other duties as directed by the committee.
5. The roles and responsibilities of other members of the Committee shall be as set out to them by the President in consultation with other members of the Committee.
6. Committee Members are entitled to be indemnified out of the Society's assets against all costs, charges, losses, expenses and liabilities incurred in the proper execution or discharge of their duties or exercise of their powers.

9 Committee Meetings

1. The Committee must meet at least once in each Full Term, and may meet outside of Full Term.
2. A Committee meeting may be convened in person, or by means that permit all Committee Members to see and hear one another in real time:
   (a) by the President; or
   (b) by any two or more Committee Members.
3. Secretary must give 48 hours' notice to all Committee Members of the date, time, venue and agenda of a Committee Meeting.
4. At a Committee Meeting:
   (a) three Committee Members constitute a quorum; and
   (b) the senior Committee Member present, in the order listed in section 10.2, must preside; and
   (c) subject to section 11.5, each Committee Member is entitled to vote; and
   (d) a resolution is made by consensus or, if a vote is required, by a simple majority of votes cast by Committee Members entitled to vote, with a casting vote made, if necessary, by the person chairing the meeting; and
   (e) votes must be cast on a show of hands unless a Committee Member requests a

secret ballot; and

(f) the Secretary or, if the Secretary is absent or is chairing the meeting, another Committee Member appointed by the person chairing the meeting must take full and accurate minutes, and must circulate them to all Committee Members promptly after the meeting; and

(g) subject to this Constitution, the meeting must be conducted as the person chairing the meeting directs.

5. A Committee Member who has a direct or indirect pecuniary interest, other than an interest that only exists by virtue of the fact that the Committee Member is a member of a class of people for whose benefit the Society is established, in a transaction made by, or in the contemplation of the Committee, must:

   (a) promptly disclose the nature and extent of the interest to the Committee; and

   (b) not take part in the deliberations or decision of the Committee with respect to that transaction.

6. The person taking the minutes of the Committee Meeting must record every disclosure made under section 9.5 in the minutes.

10 Removal of Committee Members

1. A committee member may be removed from office for seriously and consistently failing to discharge their duties or for conduct that has been seriously detrimental to the interests of the society or incompatible with its objectives. The procedure for removal must afford the person fair notice of the meeting and the basis for the motion, and a reasonable opportunity to be heard. The decision must be made by a two-thirds majority vote at a general meeting, and a process for appeal must be included as per the complaints/grievance procedure (Section 15).

11 General Meetings

1. The Society may, by motion passed at a General Meeting, transact all business and exercise all powers that may be transacted or exercised by or on behalf of an unincorporated association in general meeting.
2. A General Meeting must not be held outside of Full Term.
3. A General Meeting may be convened:

   (a) by resolution made by the Committee; or

   (b) if the Committee is unable to act, by the Senior Treasurer; or

   (c) by a petition addressed to the Secretary signed by at least 10 Members.

4. The Secretary must give seven days' notice to all Members of the date, time and venue of a General Meeting.
5. Any Member may submit a motion for discussion at a General Meeting by giving five days' notice to the Secretary of that motion.

6. A motion must have a proposer and a seconder, at least one of whom must be an Ordinary Member.
7. At a General Meeting:
   (a) 10 Ordinary Members physically present in person, at least three of whom must be Committee Members, constitute a quorum; and
   (b) the senior Committee Member present, in the order listed in section 10.2, must preside; and
   (c) each Ordinary Member physically present in person is entitled to vote, or, provided they submit a written request for proxy vote to the secretary with at least 24 hours notice, an Ordinary Member may get another Ordinary Member to vote on their behalf; and
   (d) a motion is passed by a simple majority of votes cast by Ordinary Members entitled to vote, with a casting vote made, if necessary, by the person chairing the meeting; and
   (e) votes must be cast on a show of hands unless an Ordinary Member requests a secret ballot; and
   (f) the Secretary or, if the Secretary is absent or is chairing the meeting, another Committee Member appointed by the person chairing the meeting must take full and accurate minutes, and must circulate them to all Members promptly after the meeting; and
   (g) subject to this Constitution, the meeting must be conducted as the person chairing the meeting directs.

12 Annual General Meeting

1. The Committee must convene an Annual General Meeting (AGM), to be held in the latter half of Lent Term.
2. The order of business should be conducted by the Secretary, and shall be
   (i) Retiring President's Remarks
   (ii) Presentation of Society Accounts
   (iii) Presentation of Referenda
   (iv) Annual Election Hustings
   (v) Any Other Business.

13 Elections

1. Elections will take place annually at the AGM (Annual General Meeting), which must be held within the last 4 weeks of Lent Term.
2. The President of the Society will act as the Returning Officer. In case of any conflict of interest, the outgoing committee will appoint an interim Returning Officer.
3. Only Ordinary Members of the society are eligible for election to committee positions.
4. The notice of the AGM and elections, including the date, time and venue, must be given to all members at least 14 days before the AGM.

5. Nominations must be submitted to the Returning Officer at least 7 days before the AGM. If desired, there may be an option to reopen nominations at the AGM.
6. Voting will take place by show of hands, unless a Member present requests for it to take place by secret ballot, and the single transferable vote system will be used. All ordinary members of the society are eligible to vote for all positions. Associate members are not eligible to vote.
7. At an election where the result is tied:
   (i) between candidates; the candidates may give a second speech and a run-off vote between the tied candidates will be held. If the result is tied again, the Returning Officer holds the casting vote.
   (ii) between a candidate and the option to re-open nominations, the position is not filled and a casual vacancy arises.

14 Casual Vacancies

1. Subject to this Constitution, a casual vacancy arises in respect of the position of a Committee Member when the Committee Member elected or co-opted to the position ceases to hold office earlier than specified in section 7.7(a).
2. Where a casual vacancy arises, the Committee may fill the position by resolving to co-opt an eligible Ordinary Member.

15 Complaints and Grievances

1. Any person may complain to the President, or if the President is the subject of the complaint, to the Secretary, because the person:
   (a) is dissatisfied with the governance or operation of the Society; or
   (b) is dissatisfied, in any way, in the person's dealing with the Society.
2. Any complaint under section 15.1 must be dealt with promptly and fairly and, where a complaint is upheld, the Society must provide an effective remedy.
3. If a complaint under section 15.1 cannot be resolved informally to the satisfaction of the person making the complaint, the President, or if the President is the subject of the complaint, the Secretary, must refer the complaint to the Senior Treasurer, who may determine the complaint and require the Society to provide an effective remedy.

16 Amendments to this Constitution

1. This Constitution may only be amended by a motion:
   (a) passed by a two-thirds majority of those physically present and voting at a General Meeting; and
   (b) approved by the Senior Treasurer.

2. The Secretary must promptly give notice of all amendments to this Constitution to all Members and to the Societies and Facilities Officer of the Trinity College Students' Union.

17 Dissolution

1. The Society may only be dissolved by a motion:
   (a) passed by a two-thirds majority of those physically present and voting at a General Meeting; and
   (b) approved by the Senior Treasurer.
2. If the Society is dissolved,
   (a) Committee Members remain in office for the purposes of winding up the affairs of the Society, collecting in all its property and income, and satisfying its debts and liabilities; and
   (b) all remaining property must be transferred to the Amalgamated Clubs Committee of the College.

Notes

1. This constitution will come into effect from 18 May 2026.
2. The Constitution was enacted in March 2011.
3. 1st Revision on 25 January 2014.
   2nd Revision on 8 March 2016
   3rd Revision on 8 March 2017
   4th Revision on 20 April 2019
   5th Revision on 10 November 2025
   6th Revision on 17 May 2026
4. If former versions of the Constitution are found, the amendment version of the constitution will be updated accordingly without the amendment of the Constitution.